Recipe 4: Designing API Routes and Custom JSON Responses

While working on "myapp," you noticed that the standard web responses aren't meeting the needs of external clients or mobile applications. The current API responses don't have consistent formatting, which makes it hard for consumers to reliably parse data. During a team meeting, you realized that it's essential to organize API responses to make them clearer and easier to use. So today, we will learn how to define API-specific routes and craft custom JSON responses that provide a clean, predictable data format. This will make client-side processing more efficient and improve the reliability of your API endpoints.

Defining API-specific Routes

Firstly, open the **routes/api.php** file in “myapp”. And then, instead of using web routes for API endpoints, you can keep API routes isolated for better management and middleware handling.

Then do add a new route that maps to a controller responsible for fetching product data as shown below: